

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

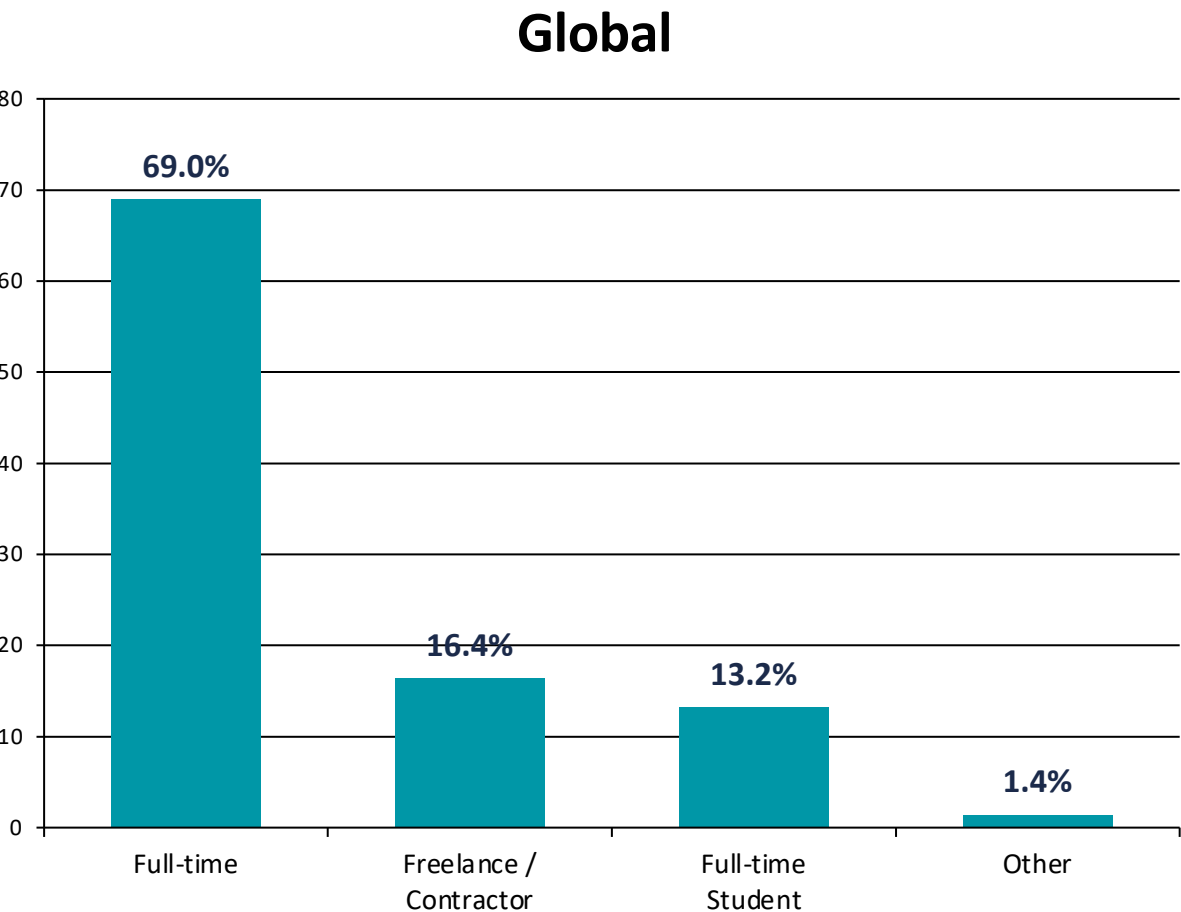
65,437 respondents across 180+ countries

Key findings on employment patterns, salary benchmarks by role and language, and workplace preferences to inform hiring and retention strategies.

Source: survey.stackoverflow.co/2024/work

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

Global employment status breakdown and U.S. full-time decline



U.S. FULL-TIME DECLINE

64.8%

U.S. full-time employment in 2024

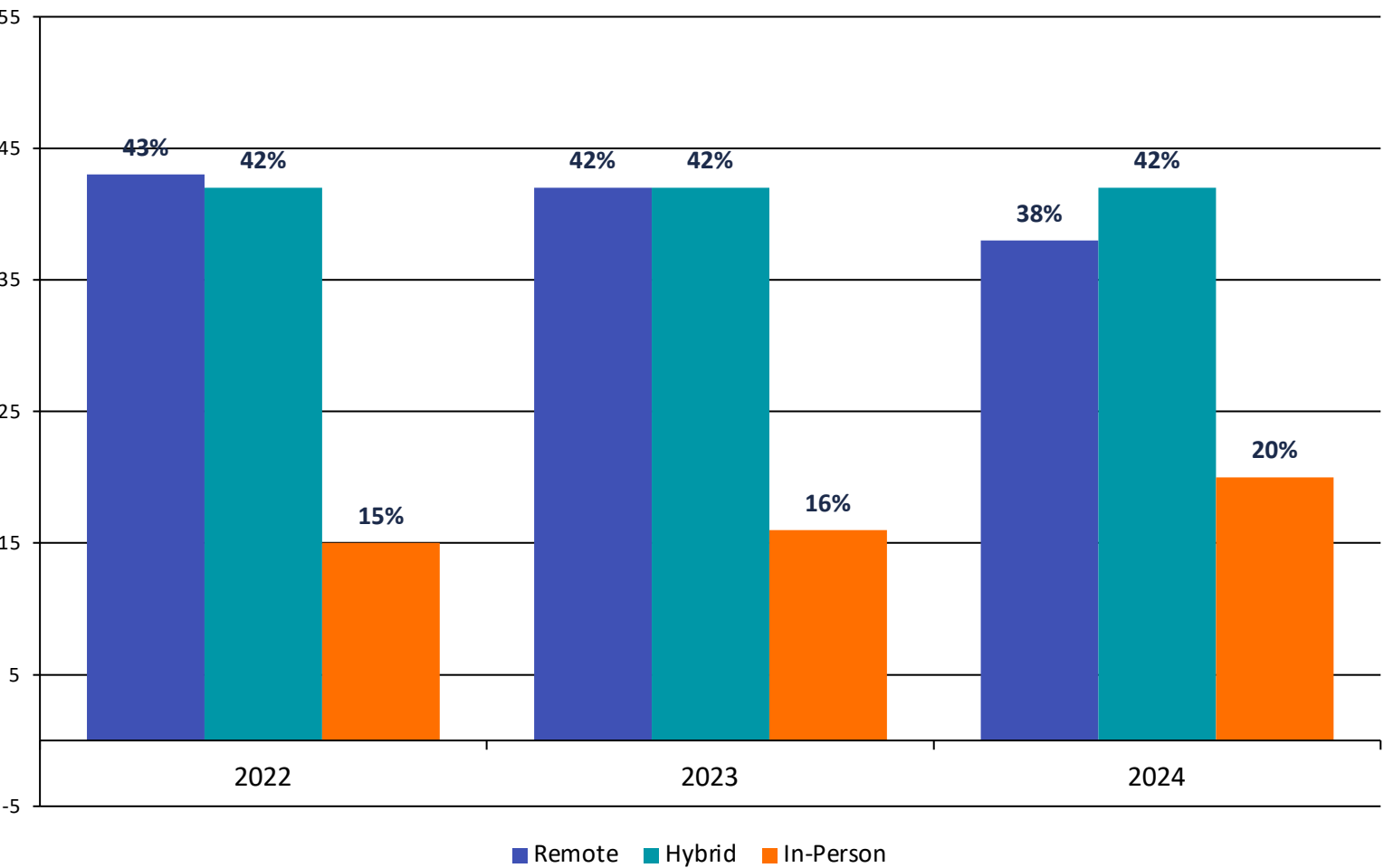
Down from 69% in 2023 (–4.2 percentage points)

In the U.K. and Ukraine, non-full-time respondents lean toward independent contracting.

In Germany and India, they are more likely to be full-time students.

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

Remote, hybrid, and in-person work trends, 2022–2024



KEY TREND

In-person work has risen for the third consecutive year — from 15% in 2022 to 20% in 2024.

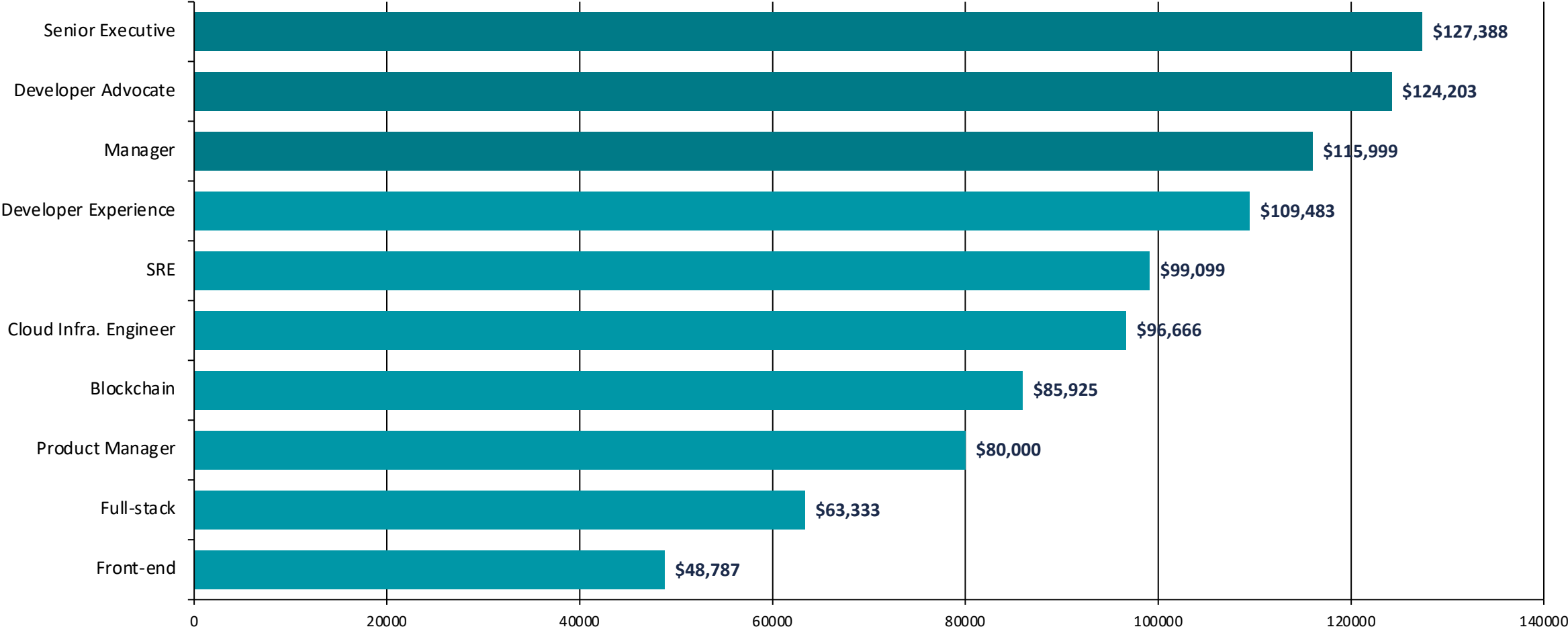
Hybrid remains the dominant arrangement at 42%, consistent with 2023.

Remote work declined from 43% to 38% over the same period.

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary

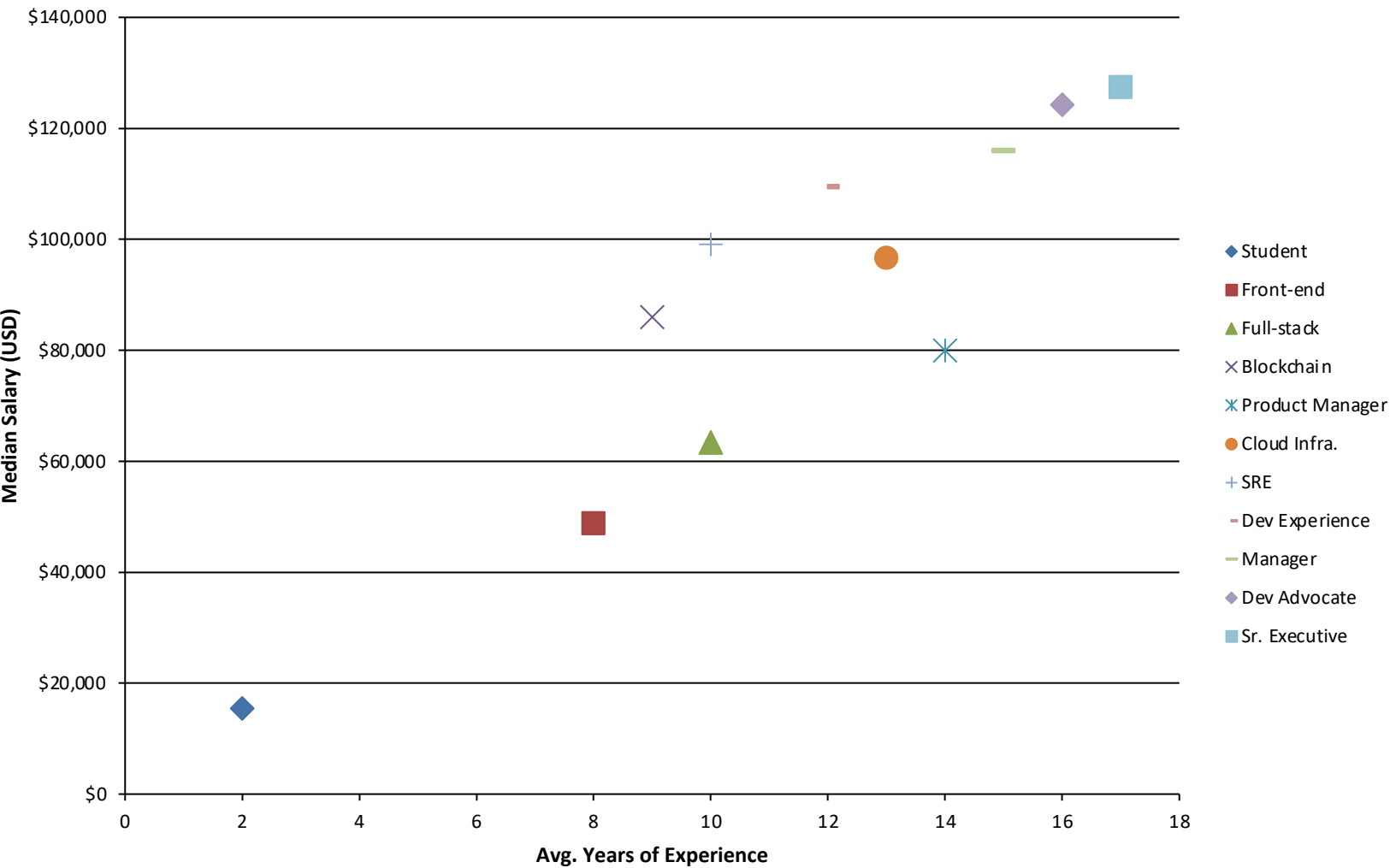
Median annual compensation (USD) by developer type — top 10 roles | 22,677 salary responses (34.7% response rate) | Ref: figure_1.jpg

Median Salary (USD)



Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

Median salary vs. average years of experience by developer type | Ref: figure_2.jpg



OUTLIER

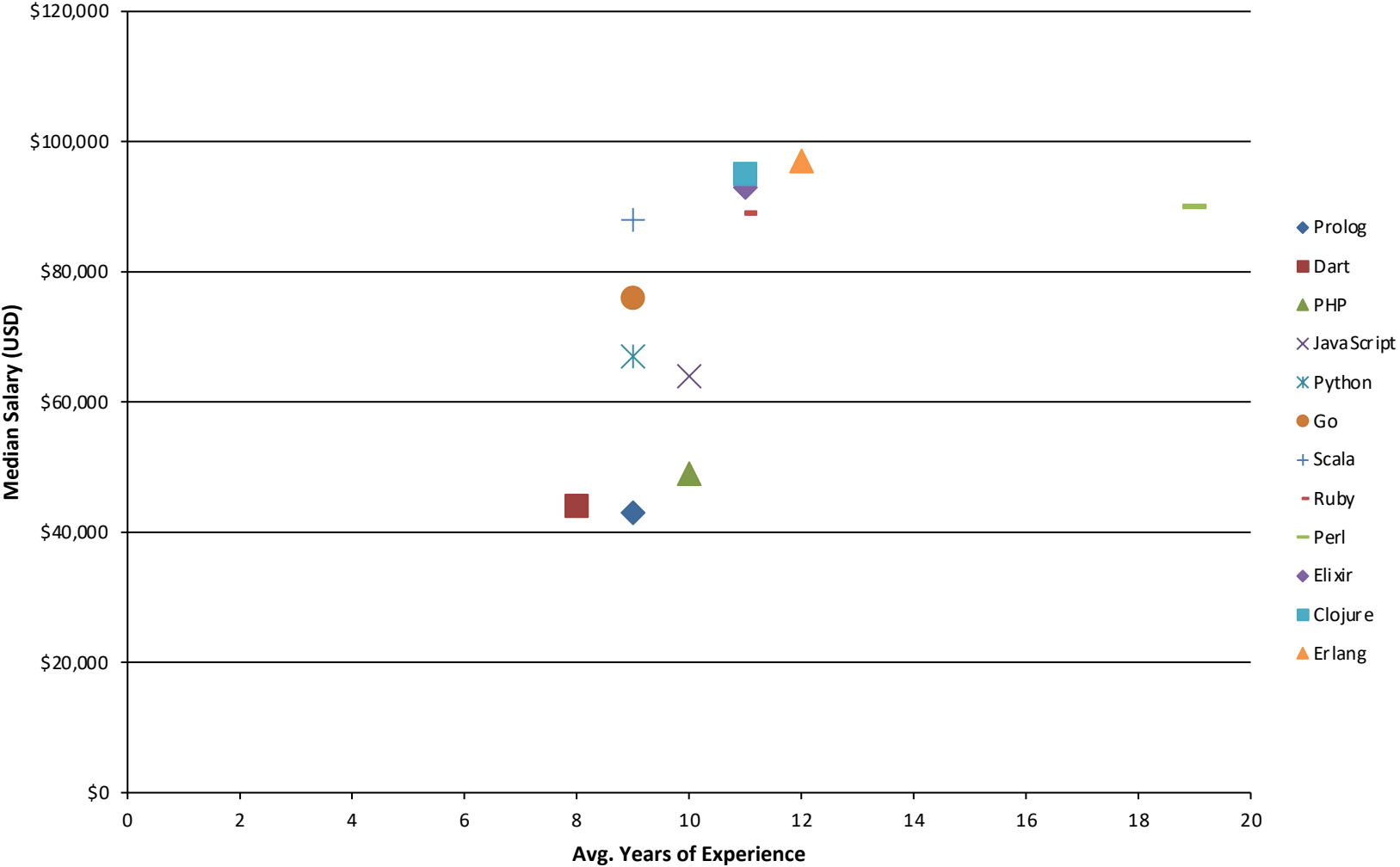
Students earn a median of \$15,466 with ~2 years experience — far below professional roles.

SRE (\$99K) and Cloud Infra. (\$97K) are the highest-paid purely technical roles.

Senior roles cluster at 14+ years and \$110K+.

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Median salary vs. average experience by programming language | Salary range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023 | Ref: figure_3.jpg



KEY INSIGHT

Niche functional languages command premium pay:

- Erlang ~\$97K (~12 yr)
- Clojure ~\$95K (~11 yr)
- Elixir ~\$93K (~11 yr)

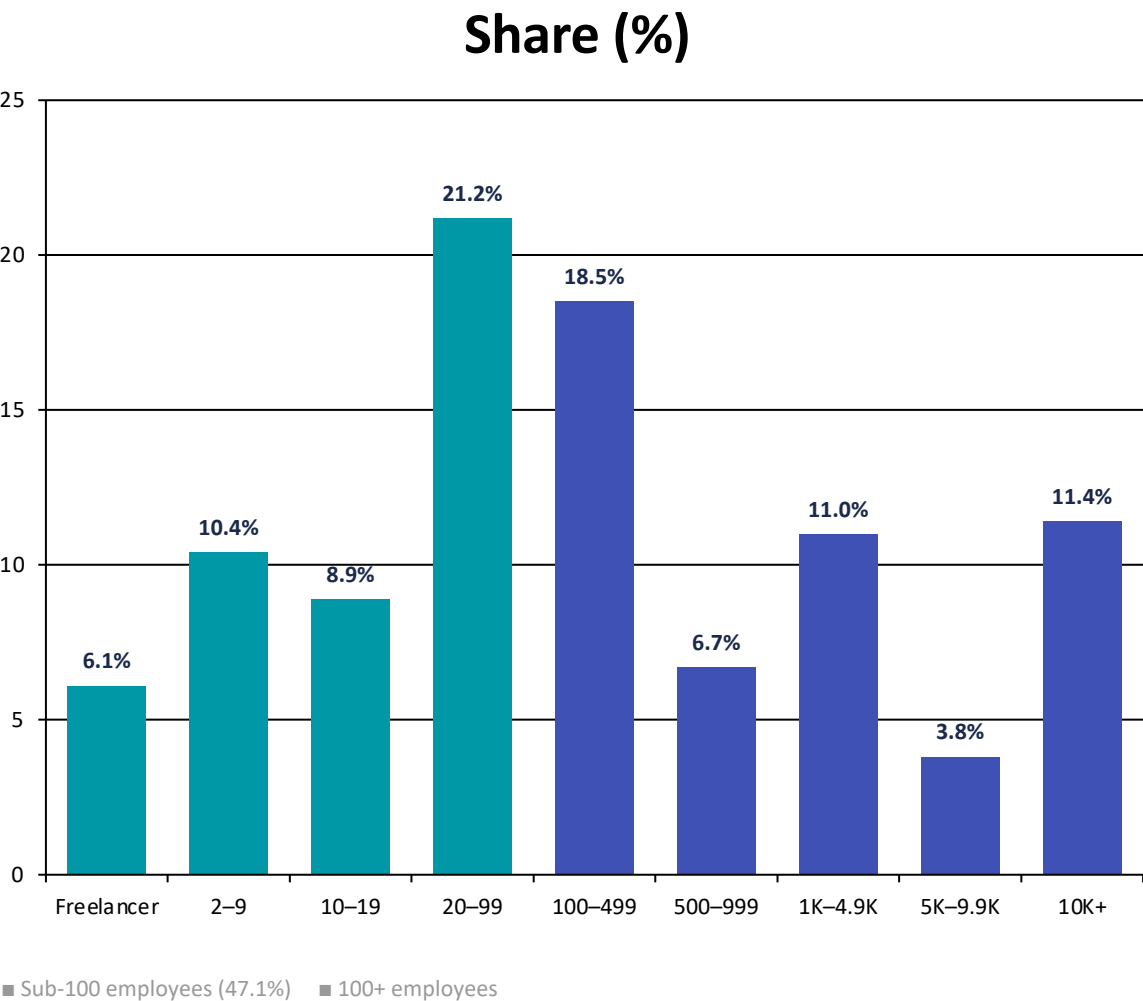
Mainstream languages lag:

- JavaScript ~\$64K
- PHP ~\$49K

Overall salary range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023.

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company size distribution (42,827 respondents) and technology purchasing influence



TECHNOLOGY PURCHASING INFLUENCE

62%

of developers influence technology purchases at their organizations

Top influencers by role:

Senior Executives — 99%

Engineering Managers — 87%

Product Managers — 77%

60% prefer a build-and-buy approach

75% start with a free trial | 73% ask other developers

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

Actionable insights for engineering leaders and HR strategists

1

Full-time employment is softening — plan for more contractors

U.S. full-time employment fell 4 percentage points YoY; freelancing remains significant at 16%+. Budget for flexible staffing models and contractor pipelines.

2

In-person mandates are growing, but hybrid still dominates

In-person rose from 15% to 20% over three years, yet 42% hybrid remains the norm. Avoid one-size-fits-all RTO policies.

3

DevRel and SRE roles command premium pay

Developer Advocates (\$124K) and SREs (\$99K) top the technical salary chart. Competitive offers are essential to recruit and retain these specialists.

4

Niche languages correlate with higher pay — factor this into hiring

Erlang, Clojure, and Elixir developers earn >\$93K median. Language specialization signals seniority and justifies premium compensation.

5

Developers influence purchasing — engage them directly

62% have a say in tech buying. Vendor strategies should target individual contributors, not just management. Free trials (75%) and peer referrals (73%) drive adoption.